

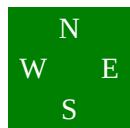
Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 5
 ♥ Q 10 9 6
 ♦ Q J 9
 ♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A 7 5 2
 ♦ A K 4
 ♣ Q J 9



♠ J 10 6 4 2
 ♥ K J 8
 ♦ 10 7 3
 ♣ K 2

♠ 9 7
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ 8 6 5 2
 ♣ A 8 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

You were prepared to lose that ♣ finesse to West so you could establish the suit in dummy.

East's play of the ♣K may have made you want to jump up with the ♣A, but you must stick to the original play of ducking one trick.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠4. West puts on the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

Needing three more winners you are going to have to establish the ♣ suit. You are also going to have to be lucky!

You win the second ♠ and play your ♣Q. East covers with the ♣K. What do you do next?

You **DUCK**. If you take the ♣A now you will never get back to dummy to enjoy those other ♣s. So let East have the ♣K. You win his return, (probably a ♠), and play ♣J, then ♣9 to dummy's ♣A. As long as ♣s split 3-2 you will get the three winners you need.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ A Q 8 7 5
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ 8 4

♠ J 9 6

♥ J 9 2

♦ Q J 10

♣ 10 9 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 3

♥ 6 3

♦ A K 5 4

♣ A Q 6 5

♠ K 10 8 2

♥ K 10 4

♦ 8 7 2

♣ K J 7

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2. North puts on the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. North will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.